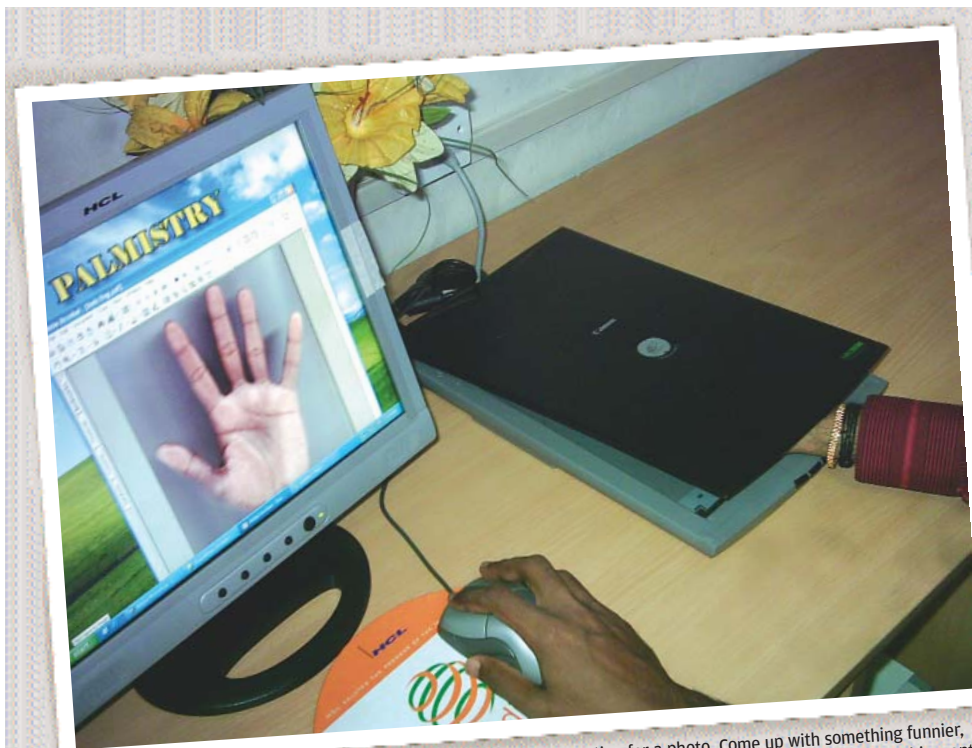




Photograph S Balaji

Each month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption

"Future Now"

Last Month's Winner!

Pratik Dey
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Bhubaneswar

"HDD: Hot Dishes Daily!"



E-mail your caption with the subject 'Beat That', and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

Beginning ActionScript 2.0

by Nathan Derksen & Jeff Berg
Published by

WILEY-INDIA



to pay if you want to read the news items.

A Google spokesman said it was early days for Archive Search: more papers will be added. Depending on how many papers "will be added," the development takes Google to new heights: instead of "organising the world's information and making it universally accessible and useful" just applying to the latest goings-on, an entire dimension—our past, our heritage—has been created.

Is this exciting stuff yet? A search for "Jalianwala Bagh" brought up about 50 results, of which three dated back to 1930 (the tragedy occurred in 1919). All three of these pages cost \$1.95 to read.

You can filter results by year, and when we searched for "india cricket world cup 1983", none of the results on the first page were about the win. Filtering it down to "1983", we could only find mention of the win in items after the event.

Still, it does give you a taste of things bygone: we

encountered such phrases as "the world's non-white cricket teams" and, in the case of the previous search, "British India, Jalianwala Bagh, Punjab, 1919: British-Indian troops opened fire..."

We'll just have to wait for Google to add more meat to the service until we see such headlines as "India gains freedom" in The First Page Of The Results.

Then, Google has augmented its book search (<http://books.google.com>) to include full-text versions of public domain titles, including such items as *Hamlet* and *Inferno*. (Earlier, only sections or select chapters were available.) You can now search by "all books" and "full-view books".

Much of the Internet

community today gets most of its information online, and Google Books could just encourage reading amongst those who don't know their Wodehouse from their Spinoza.

And there's more. Google has re-released an open source OCR software originally produced by HP: the Tesseract program. It was developed by HP between 1985 and 1995; HP then stopped working on it and released the code. By Google's own admission, the software currently "supports only English, does not include a page layout analysis module, struggles with greyscale and colour documents, and will not match the accuracy of the best commercial OCR packages currently available."

In another development, Google Earth tied up with the United Nations Environmental Program (www.unep.org) to allow users to see images that depict areas of the most extreme environmental degradation. It will offer before-and-after imagery

